

Anti-piracy. What's up with that?

sunnydiv
Digitized!

When I look around, I see all the companies using and looking for better anti-piracy techniques; I want to put forward a question.

Do they really work? As far as I know they don't, all they do is cause more and more pain to those who purchase the original copies, pirates always find a way to pirate!

Example: Microsoft XP! Now they are asking real buyers to call Microsoft to activate Windows. And you have to do this on every reinstall!!! For Pirates, a simple and easy keygen; no call, no nothing, put in key and its done

Games: Real buyers have to insert the CD every time they play, lose the CD and that's about it for them. Pirated games are copy protection free, you can make an ISO image, you can even find a crack where the CD isn't required.

Now they are working on inbuilt hardware piracy protection; that's going to give the real buyer more problems.

Software companies need to remember: They are only causing pain to the people who actually pay. And Pirates, always find a way

rajkumar_personal
Resident Techie

A POST THAT NEEDS EVERY1's attention! Well said mate! Hope that many ppl take notice and do something about it!

gamefreak14
Digitized!

Sunnydiv, Your colourful explanation of pirates being the happiest really opened my eyes. I never knew such a free, free world ever existed. And all this while, I was being tortured. Why discuss the obvious? There are people who'll even "pirate" Linux. Anti-piracy measures are intended to stop casual piracy—of the harmless kind.

I lost Rs 500 when I lost my wallet yesterday. Since I couldn't make an ISO of my cash, I expect you to reimburse it. Got it?

goobimama
Resident Techie

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I'll tell you an incident with an original Windows Installations. My friend, who had opted for the government scheme "The Cyberage Scheme" got a computer with Windows XP Home Edition installed. Now, somewhere down the line something got screwed up (as it always does). So, he asked me how to reinstall. After reinstalling, he had to activate it. No modem. So, he tries dialling those numbers that were given. Always engaged. Gets really frustrated and asks me what to do. I go and install my pirated copy of Windows XP Professional with SP2 (Microsoft claims "only original Windows has SP2"!)." He's happy now. Pirates and crackers will always find a way, they are smarter than those who created the software. Also, as the saying goes "everything that is made can be broken"

Putting A Spim On It

Sachin Kalbag's editorial on the issue of mobile spam or spim ('Don't piss me off', March 2005) had just the right tone. I am not a regular victim of spim, but I completely agree with the need for iron-cast laws on spimming. We have already entered the era of low cost text messaging, and it is high time authorities took notice of the inherent dangers of spim-and take action to protect our privacy and rights.

The problem is, in a technologically illiterate nation-headed mostly by equally illiterate ministers-how do we make our leaders sit up and take notice of this gradually-spreading evil?

I believe spimming is illegal in the US, or at least, some sort of legal recourse can be taken against it by victims. But can this be happen in India?

The March editorial couldn't have come at a better time. Given current trends, mobiles seem to be the ideal gateway for the Indian masses into the digital world, as these gadgets provide cheap computing and connectivity to a number far greater than those with access to a PC. Therefore, the problem of spim will increase only exponentially as the market expands.

It will be compounded when mobile phones become the preferred Internet gateway, which is inevitable. It needs to be nipped in the bud. Now!

You suggest that we all call them back and give them a piece of our minds. But I don't think they (the spimmers) will be bothered one bit—they are thick-skinned enough to simply ignore the few angry calls they get.



The ThinkDigit blog: By the readers and for the readers

I find it hard to visualise technocrats putting up a 'dharna' to ban spim! Nor would politicians understand the importance of such a law.

Whatever the case may be, the situation is definitely going to get worse in the coming years.

Arjun R
Via e-mail

The law isn't a solution either: on what grounds do we punish them? Doing business via SMS? Sending unsolicited SMSes? If there were such a law, it would be the most misused law in the country, and could be used by anyone against anybody.

The solution, I think, must be implemented at the service provider's end as in the case of spam. Somebody (Digit, perhaps?) is bound to figure out a way to do so, before the problem gets out of hand.

Ojas Amalnerkar
Via e-mail



Dear Arjun and Ojas, Digit's editorials usually reflect what most technology users are thinking about at any given point in time. Spimming is indeed a menace that deserves the axe; and the earlier the better. The trouble with taking a legal recourse in India is also that it is a long-drawn process. Besides, it may be in the media's spotlight for a day or two, and then everybody gets back to their respective jobs. For instance, has a single print publication